

Robert H Lawson

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SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer with 10+ years delivering production-grade data pipelines and cloud data platforms for healthcare and enterprise SaaS. Expert in ETL/ELT, data modeling, data quality, and lakehouse/warehouse architectures. Proven track record driving scalable analytics infrastructure, improving data reliability, and accelerating time-to-insight. Hands-on with Python, Spark, SQL, Kubernetes, Terraform, and data orchestration (Airflow, Flyte). Adept at partnering with analytics, product, and data science teams to design schemas, data contracts, and SLAs, while leading design sessions and mentoring engineers.

SKILLS

- Data Processing: ETL/ELT, data ingestion, data harmonization, data cleansing, deduplication
- Data Modeling: Dimensional modeling, star schemas, semantic layer design
- Data Warehousing & Lakehouse: Delta Lake, Snowflake, Redshift, PostgreSQL
- Orchestration: Airflow, Flyte
- Cloud Platforms / Storage: AWS (S3), data lakehouse architectures
- Infrastructure / DevOps: Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, CI/CD
- Data Quality / Observability: Great Expectations, Prometheus, Grafana
- Governance & Collaboration: Data contracts, SLAs, data lineage, stakeholder engagement

EXPERIENCE

CloudScale – Senior Data Engineer

Feb 2022 – May 2025 | Remote

- Led design and production of a centralized data ingestion platform onboarding 15+ application data feeds into a Delta Lake on S3, reducing data onboarding time by 40% and enabling scalable lakehouse analytics.
- Implemented scalable PySpark ETL pipelines for cleansing, deduplication, and transformation of clinical and operational datasets; processed up to 1 TB/day with <2% error rate.
- Built automated data quality checks and monitoring using Great Expectations + Prometheus, cutting silent data issues by 70% and enabling proactive issue resolution.
- Managed pipeline deployments and infrastructure as code with Terraform and Kubernetes, delivering reproducible environments and zero-downtime rollouts.
- Developed role-based data delivery to analytics platforms (Snowflake, Redshift), improving query performance and reducing analyst wait time by 50%.
- Led client-facing design sessions, workshops, and architecture diagrams; created data contracts, SLAs, and documentation to guide downstream consumers.
- Mentored data engineers, established best practices, and fostered a culture of continuous learning and growth.

TechNova Systems – Data Engineer

Nov 2019 – Feb 2022 | Austin, TX

- Designed and maintained end-to-end ETL pipelines in Python and Spark to ingest multi-source telemetry and clinical feeds into the company data lake.
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Implemented schema-on-read and partitioning strategies in S3/Delta Lake to optimize Spark jobs and reduce costs by 30%.

- Built SQL-based data models and dimensional schemas in Redshift for reporting and BI; improved report latency and accuracy.
- Automated orchestration with Airflow and migrated multiple workflows to Flyte for improved scalability and lineage tracking.
- Implemented automated unit and integration tests for data pipelines and CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions.
- Partnered with analytics and product teams to onboard new data sources, define KPIs, and ensure timely delivery of clean datasets.

LoneStar Digital Solutions – Data Engineer

Aug 2014 – Oct 2019 | Austin, TX

- Developed ETL frameworks and reusable components in Python to harmonize healthcare claims, EHR extracts, and operational logs from 3+ sources.
- Built Spark-based transformations to normalize clinical vocabularies, perform de-duplication, and populate analytical schemas used by clinical teams.
- Deployed containerized pipeline services to Kubernetes; managed manifests with Helm; provisioned cloud infrastructure with Terraform.
- Implemented monitoring dashboards (Grafana) and job-level alerts to ensure pipeline health and minimize downtime.
- Collaborated with healthcare clients to map source schemas to target models and validate clinical data quality for production use.
- Documented data lineage and created onboarding guides to accelerate future source integrations by 60%.

EDUCATION

Texas Tech University

BS in Computer Science, Aug 2010 – May 2014 | Austin, TX